ACS Year II, sem.1
COURSE: CTLS
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SEMINAR 6: ORAL PRESENTATIONS – BODY LANGUAGE AND RHETORICAL DEVICES

I. BODY LANGUAGE

1) Alex Lyon on verbal and nonverbal communication
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wOhLMEKLTKE
2) Paul Ekman on how to catch a liar https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wq-poN6sLF8 –

Paul Ekman is a famous psychologist and emeritus professor at UCLA, whose theory of the universality of emotions has proved extremely valuable and influential in studying facial expressions in various fields, from police investigations to the animation entertainment industry, to psychological practice or public speaking. According to Eckman, people across the world experience the same emotions, but what varies is the manner of manifesting them according to the cultural background one belongs to. Professor Ekman has also been the scientific consultant for the American detective TV series *Lie to Me* (2009-2011) starring Tim Roth as doctor Cal Lightman, specialized in body language and microexpressions. Being able to recognize one's own emotions and other people's emotions through facial expressions is a perfectible skill which may increase our empathy towards one another, thus improving our relationships.

II. RHETORICAL DEVICES

Logos (reason), *ethos* (character) and *pathos* (emotion) are the 3 main modes of persuasion a public speaker should use when addressing an audience. In order to reach these levels, a speaker can utilize diverse rhetorical devices (*antithesis* or *contrast*, *rhetorical questions*, *metaphor*, *anaphora*, *parallelism*, *analogy*, *hyperbole*, *repetition*, *inversion* etc.) that make the content of the speech more attractive to a certain type of audience. Besides rhetorical techniques, body language and non-verbal communication support the speaker's message to the respective audience. Ideally, a speaker should maintain a perfect balance between the appeal to reason, the appeal to his/her personality and the appeal to the audience's emotions. In practice, striking this balance is not an easy task, but a speaker can always improve his/her arguments and the style of delivering them.

1) Alex Lyon on rhetorical devices for persuasion
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qFRciL2P4s4
2) Read the following excerpt from Martin Luther King Jr.'s *I Have a Dream Speech*. You can also watch the video for a more accurate perception at
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3vDWWy4CMhE

Then answer the questions below.

I say to you today, my friends.

And so even though we face the difficulties of today and tomorrow, I still have a dream. It is a dream deeply rooted in the American dream.

I have a dream that one day this nation will rise up and live out the true meaning of its creed: "We hold these truths to be self-evident, that all men are created equal."

I have a dream that one day on the red hills of Georgia, the sons of former slaves and the sons of former slave owners will be able to sit down together at the table of brotherhood.

I have a dream that one day even the state of Mississippi, a state sweltering with the heat of injustice, sweltering with the heat of oppression, will be transformed into an oasis of freedom and justice.

I have a dream that my four little children will one day live in a nation where they will not be judged by the color of their skin but by the content of their character.

I have a dream today (...).

(Martin Luther King Jr., I Have a Dream, 28 August 1963)

1) What does the fragment speak about?

2) Explain in your own words the connection between the concept of ”the American dream” and the sentence ”We hold these truths to be self-evident, that all men are created equal”.

3) What is the main rhetorical device used in this excerpt and what is its role?

4) Identify 2 other rhetorical devices used in this fragment and explain their role.

5) What is your opinion of this excerpt?